

Document 4: Attendance & Condonation Rules

Institution: Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT)

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1. The Core Statutory Attendance Mandate

Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT) strictly enforces a mandatory attendance policy to ensure that students derive maximum benefit from classroom instruction, peer interaction, and laboratory practice. The university views attendance not merely as a physical presence, but as a primary metric of academic discipline and professional readiness.

To be deemed eligible to receive a Hall Ticket and appear for the Semester End Examinations (SEE), every undergraduate student must mathematically secure a minimum of 75% aggregate attendance across all registered courses for that specific semester. This 75% threshold is absolute. The university calculation system does not employ mathematical rounding. For instance, an aggregate attendance of 74.9% will be officially recorded as falling below the 75% requirement.

Attendance is calculated from the official commencement date of the semester, as declared in the academic calendar, regardless of whether a student registers late or pays their tuition fees after the deadline. Students who join the semester during the late registration window will automatically lose attendance for all classes conducted prior to their registration date.

2. Biometric Tracking and Classroom Entry Protocols

HIT utilizes a dual-authentication attendance tracking system to eliminate discrepancies, proxy attendance, and human error.

Every lecture hall, laboratory, and seminar room is equipped with a Radio Frequency Identification (RFID) scanner at the entrance. Students must tap their encoded university ID cards on the scanner upon entering the room. Simultaneously, the faculty member will conduct a manual roll call or circulate a biometric fingerprint scanner during the first fifteen minutes of the lecture.

- **The 10-Minute Grace Rule:** For a standard one-hour theoretical lecture, students are granted a strict 10-minute grace period from the ringing of the bell. Any student entering the classroom on the 11th minute or later is legally permitted to sit and listen to the lecture to avoid missing academic content, but they will be permanently marked as "Absent" in the digital registry for that specific hour.
- **Proxy Attendance Violations:** Attempting to tap another student's RFID card or manipulate the biometric scanner is classified as a severe disciplinary offense. If a student is caught logging proxy attendance, both the student who provided the ID card and the student who scanned it will immediately lose all attendance accumulated in that specific subject for the entire semester, resetting their metric to zero percent.

3. Medical Condonation and Emergency Leaves

The university recognizes that students may face genuine, unforeseen medical emergencies, prolonged hospitalizations, or severe contagious illnesses (such as Dengue, Typhoid, or COVID-19) that prevent them from attending classes. To accommodate these genuine crises, the university offers a Medical Condonation Window.

If a student's aggregate attendance falls below the standard 75% requirement, but remains strictly at or above 65%, they become eligible to apply for medical condonation.

To successfully claim medical condonation, the student must adhere to a rigid administrative workflow:

1. **Immediate Notification:** The student or their parent must notify the assigned Faculty Advisor via official university email within 48 hours of the medical emergency commencing.
2. **Documentation Submission:** Upon returning to campus, the student has exactly 5 working days to submit a physical 'Leave of Absence' form to the Head of the Department.
3. **Required Evidence:** The form must be accompanied by a government-approved hospital discharge summary, original medical prescriptions, and a fitness certificate signed by a Chief Medical Officer indicating the exact dates the student was advised bed rest.
4. **Committee Review:** Standard pharmacy receipts or letters from private clinics for minor ailments like the common cold or headaches will be instantly rejected by the Departmental Attendance Committee.

If the student's attendance falls to 64.9% or below, medical condonation cannot be applied under any circumstances, even if the student was hospitalized for the entire semester.

4. On-Duty (OD) Leaves for Extracurricular and Professional Activities

HIT encourages students to participate in national hackathons, inter-university sports tournaments, official paper presentations, and short-term corporate workshops. Students representing the university in such events are protected from attendance loss through the granting of "On-Duty" (OD) leaves.

However, OD leaves are not granted retroactively. To secure OD status, students must follow the pre-approval protocol:

- **Prior Permission:** The student must submit an OD application form, signed by the faculty sponsor or the Director of Physical Education, to the Academic Dean at least 3 days before departing the campus.
- **Maximum Cap:** A student can claim a maximum of 14 days of OD leave per semester. Any days missed beyond this 14-day cap for extracurricular activities will be logged as standard absences.
- **Proof of Participation:** Within 3 days of returning to campus, the student must submit the original participation certificate or a letter from the event organizer. Failure to submit this proof will result in the OD status being revoked, and the days will be converted to unexcused absences.
- **Exclusions:** OD leaves cannot be claimed for organizing internal college cultural festivals, participating in student club meetings, or attending private family functions.

5. The Detention Policy (Shortage of Attendance)

The most severe consequence of violating the university's attendance rules is Academic Detention. Detention implies that the student is legally barred from taking the Semester End Examinations and will not receive any academic credits for that term, effectively freezing their degree progression.

- **Absolute Detention Threshold:** Any student whose final aggregate attendance, after factoring in all approved OD leaves, strictly falls below 65% is automatically declared "Detained due to Shortage of Attendance."
- **Consequences of Detention:** A detained student loses the entire academic semester. They are not permitted to write the final exams, they cannot sit for supplementary exams, and they are temporarily suspended from the university rolls.
- **Re-Registration Requirement:** To clear a detained semester, the student must wait until the exact same semester is offered in the following academic year (e.g., a student detained in the 3rd semester must wait a full year to rejoin the next batch of 3rd-semester students). They must pay the full semester tuition fee again, attend all classes from day one, and satisfy the 75% attendance requirement anew.

6. Financial Slabs for Condonation Fees

If a student's attendance falls into the condonation window (between 65% and 74.9%), and their medical or emergency justification is approved by the committee, they must still pay a financial penalty to officially process the condonation and release their Hall Ticket.

The university applies a tiered financial penalty system to discourage students from intentionally hovering near the minimum requirements:

- **Tier 1 Shortage (70.0% to 74.9%):** Students falling in this bracket must pay a flat condonation processing fee of ₹1,000.
- **Tier 2 Shortage (65.0% to 69.9%):** Students in this critical bracket must pay a higher base fee of ₹2,500, plus submit a mandatory undertaking signed by their parents acknowledging the severe attendance shortage.
- **Late Payment Penalty:** Condonation fees must be paid through the online student portal at least 48 hours before the first scheduled final exam. If a student attempts to pay on the day of the examination, an additional emergency processing fine of ₹500 is levied.

7. Grievance Redressal and Attendance Disputes

HIT maintains a transparent, digital attendance ledger. Students can view their real-time, subject-wise attendance percentage on their mobile portal 24/7. Because this data is continuously available, students are expected to monitor their own academic standing.

If a student believes a faculty member has incorrectly marked them absent, or if an RFID scanner malfunctioned, they have exactly 72 hours from the time of the alleged error to raise a dispute. The student must file a digital ticket with the IT Helpdesk and simultaneously inform the subject teacher. The teacher will review the manual roll call sheet or cross-reference the CCTV footage of the lecture hall if necessary.

Disputes raised at the end of the semester regarding attendance shortages from months prior will be summarily dismissed by the administration. The university operates on the principle that real-time tracking demands real-time accountability from the student body.